

routines from sources like Gold's Gym and Men's Fitness, making this an excellent choice for fitness beginners.

VR Headsets

In the context of a wearable, VR headsets are arguably the future. The functions provided by fitness bands and smartwatches can also be delivered by high-end smartwatches and other peripheral devices. However, VR headsets are a unique type of hardware, and the experience they provide is something that has to be understood first hand to truly appreciate.

VR headsets have yet to achieve mainstream popularity as none—with the exception of Samsung's Gear VR are actually available for end consumer purchase. Pioneering devices like the Oculus Rift and the HTC Vive are available only as developers editions, which are very expensive and still in an experimental state.

However, game developers and hardware engineers have identified the potential of these devices, and this looks like it may as well be the landmark year for VR headset, with the much-anticipated consumer release of the Oculus Rift and HTC Vive slated for the end of the year. With that in mind, let's take a closer look at some of the VR headsets that show some promise for the future of virtual reality.

Oculus Rift

From what began as the successful result of a very popular Kickstarter campaign, the Oculus Rift has undergone numerous transformations and redesigns from its initial model the Developer Kit 1 (aka DK1). With an intermediate iterations known as Crystal Cove and DK2, the final version has been code named Crescent Bay and looks most likely to be the final version in terms of hardware.

The device houses an ARM processor and a proprietary 'Adjacent Reality Tracker', which is which in essence is collection of sensors used for head tracking. The Rift uses an HDMI cable for input and USB 2.0 for power. It can be interfaced with a PC for firmware updates and analyzing sensor stats. The headset also includes a in microUSB port for added connectivity. It is strapped onto your head via vertical and horizontal straps, and is fairly comfortable, although not for extended use.

When developing the Crescent Bay, Oculus effectively reduced the overall weight and added an inbuilt audio processor and tracking LEDs that allowed for 360-degree head tracking. It also supports high-speed